

DEATH NOTE L'S GAME



HOW TO PLAY 1 - INTRODUCTION

This game is designed for Play-by-Post or Play-by-Chat format. It requires a Gamemaster (GM) and 5-8 Players. The identities of the Players should be hidden until the end of the game. The Players should contact the GM privately to sign up, and they should provide a name to identify them during play. They should never post the actions of their turns, instead sending them directly to the GM, who then publicly posts them.

HOW TO PLAY 2 - SETUP

The GM starts by secretly assigning a Role to each Player. One to be Kira, one to be L, one to be Worshipper, and the rest are made Investigators. The GM then assigns a random turn order, designating which Player goes first, second, third, and so on. Play then proceeds in that order.

HOW TO PLAY 3 - PLAYER STATISTICS

Each Player has three Statistics that they and the GM will keep track of. The Statistics are: Suspicion, Trust, and Voice Power (VP). Each Statistic can have a value of 0 to 100. At the beginning of the game, Suspicion and Trust start at 0/100, and VP starts at 100/100. Of these stats, only Trust should be public information, and thus GM should keep an immediately updated list to be posted whenever there is a change in someone's Trust.



HOW TO PLAY 4 - ORDER OF PLAY

L's Game is played out over a number of Phases, Turns, and Rounds. Each Round begins with the Debate Phase. After each Player has had 3 Turns during the Debate Phase, the Round progresses to the Justice Phase, and finally the L's Reasoning and Kira's Judgment Phase. Once all Phases are complete, the Round ends and a new one begins. This continues until a winner is decided.

HOW TO PLAY 5 - WIN CONDITION

The Goal of the game differs depending on your Role. L and the Investigators win if Kira is eliminated during the Justice Phase. Kira and the Worshipper win if L is eliminated during either the Justice Phase or Kira's Judgment Phase, or if Kira and L are the only remaining Players.



HOW TO PLAY 6 - ROLE ABILITIES

To help their 'side' win, each Role has a special ability. L can use the L's Reasoning Phase each Round to determine whether or not a Player is Kira. Kira can use the Kira's Judgment Phase to eliminate a Player, but at the cost of halving their maximum VP. Worshipper starts knowing which Player is Kira. Investigators start knowing Information, which comes in one of three forms, either knowledge of 2 Players who could be L (one is L, the other is not), 2 Players who are not L, or 1 Player who is the Worshipper; no two Investigator's information is exactly the same.

HOW TO PLAY 7 - SUSPICION

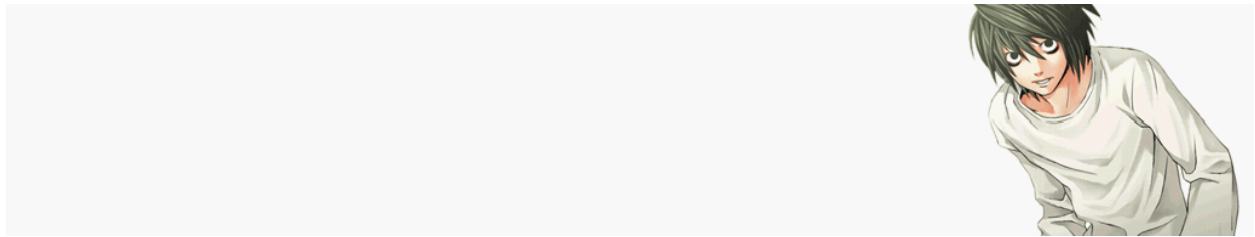
Suspicion is a visual and numerical way to determine who the group thinks is most likely to be Kira. At the beginning of the game, each Player starts with 0/100 Suspicion. The Statistic is hidden, with only the GM and Player themselves knowing the exact number of their current Suspicion level. However, when a Player reaches 40+ Suspicion, a single Checkmark is publicly added to their name; and when a Player reaches 80+ Suspicion, a second Checkmark is added. Whenever a Player's Suspicion reaches one of these milestones, the GM will announce it.

HOW TO PLAY 8 - TRUST

Trust governs the spread of Investigator Information and the ability for Players to privately contact each other. Each Player has a separate Trust level for each other Player. Trust is never a hidden Statistic, always visible and public. At the beginning of the game, everyone's Trust levels start at 0/100. When a Player's Trust with another Player reaches 100, the other Player must send the Player their Information. When both Players are at 100 Trust with each other, they may, through the GM, at any time, send private messages of any content or length to each other. Whenever a Player reaches 100 Trust with another Player, the GM will announce it.

HOW TO PLAY 9 - FALSE INFORMATION

As neither L, Kira, or the Worshipper begin the game with Information, they will have to fabricate their own Information when a Player reaches 100 Trust with them. This potentially 'False' Information must follow the same guidelines for Investigator Information laid out in HOW TO PLAY 6. This Information does not have to be true or consistent, and thus it's possible to send different Information to different Players.



HOW TO PLAY 10 - DEBATE PHASE

During the Debate Phase, the Players decide who among them is Kira. On their Turn, a Player may either make a Proposal (say something targeted at someone), Remark (say something in general), or Pass (say nothing). On another Player's Turn, a Player may choose to Agree or Disagree with the Turn Player's Proposal, starting an Argument, which can then be Maintained. It costs VP to make a Proposal or Remark, and Players are similarly required to spend VP when Agreeing, Disagreeing, or Maintaining an Argument. Players recover 40 VP at the beginning of their Turns. Once every Player has had 3 Turns, the Debate Phase ends, every Player's VP is restored to its current maximum, and play proceeds to the Justice Phase.

HOW TO PLAY 11 - VOICE POWER

Voice Power represents a Player's ability to speak. Each Player begins the game with 100 VP, with a maximum of 100. The maximum can be lowered. Kira loses half their maximum when they choose to eliminate a Player during the Kira's Judgment Phase (100/100 becomes 50/50), and L loses 20 of their max VP each time an Investigator or the Worshipper is eliminated during the Justice Phase. During the Debate Phase, Players spend VP to make Proposals, Remarks, Agree, Disagree, or Maintain an Argument. It usually costs 1 VP to speak 1 word, but this 'exchange rate' typically varies based on action being taken. Titles, names, nicknames, and numbers always count as 1 word. Players recover 40 VP at the beginning of each their Turns, and they recover VP up to their maximum at the end of the Debate Phase. A Player's VP can never exceed their maximum.



HOW TO PLAY 12 - PROPOSALS

To make a Proposal, a Player chooses a Tone and another Player to be the 'Target'. They then create a message to go with the Proposal, which costs a varying amount of VP per word, based on the Tone chosen. The Player finishes by sending the entire Proposal to the GM, who then posts it publicly. Once posted, the GM randomly contacts another Player, asking whether they'd like to Agree, Disagree, or Pass (say nothing). If the contacted Player chooses to Pass, the GM randomly contacts another Player, asking the same thing, until all other Players have been contacted; if this happens, the Proposal 'goes through'. If a Player chooses to Agree, the Proposal immediately goes through. If a Player chooses to Disagree, an Argument is started.



HOW TO PLAY 13 - TONES

When a Player makes a Proposal, they choose a Tone for their message from HOW TO PLAY 14. The chosen Tone determines the 'effect' and 'effectiveness' of the Proposal, causing it to raise/lower the Target Player's Trust and Suspicion by different amounts, as well as altering the VP per word cost ratio. Each Tone has a minimum cost, but no maximum cost. There is no 'minimum word count'. The effectiveness of a Tone is determined by its minimum cost or its word count, whichever is higher.

HOW TO PLAY 14 - LIST OF TONES

|| Name: Effect, minimum VP cost, VP to word cost ratio, effectiveness per word.

|| Weak Accusation: Raise Suspicion and lower Trust, minimum 5 VP, 1 VP per Word, +/- 1 per Word.

|| Powerful Accusation: Greatly raise Suspicion and lower Trust, minimum 20 VP, 4 VP per Word, +/- 4 per Word.

|| Gentle Accusation: Raise Suspicion only, minimum 20 VP, 4 VP per Word, + 1 per Word.

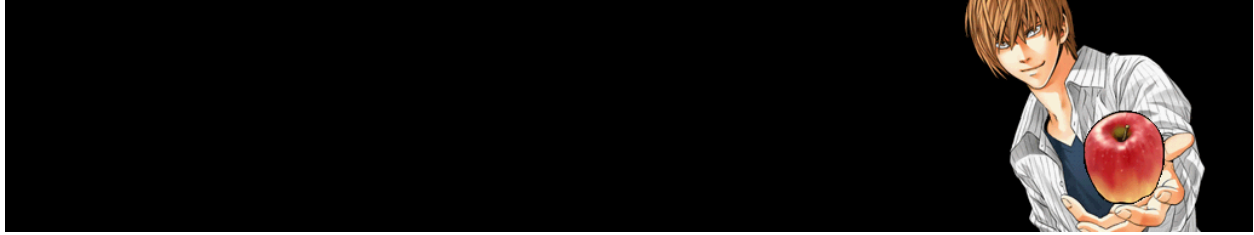
|| Careful Accusation: Greatly raise Suspicion only, minimum 40 VP, 8 VP per Word, +4 per Word.

|| Weak Commendation: Raise Trust and lower Suspicion, minimum 5 VP, 1 VP per Word, +/- 1 per Word.

|| Powerful Commendation: Greatly raise Trust and lower Suspicion, minimum 20 VP, 4 VP per Word, +/- 4 per Word.

HOW TO PLAY 15 - REMARKS

While Proposals are always directed at a individual Player, Remarks are aimed at either the entire group of Players or no one in particular. They have a high VP cost and cannot be 'challenged' (be targeted by a Agree or Disagree), so a Remark always 'goes through'. To make a Remark, a Player chooses a Remark from the list of Remarks in HOW TO PLAY 16, creating a message to go along with it. This works just like a Proposal (HOW TO PLAY 12), except the Player is not allowed to mention the name of another Player (i.e. a Remark is never allowed to have a 'Target'). Also, unlike Tones, the 'effectiveness' of a Remark is always based on its wordcount, unless it has a static effect.



HOW TO PLAY 16 - LIST OF REMARKS

- || Raise everyone's Suspicion, minimum 70 VP, 14 VP per Word, + 1 per Word.
- || Lower everyone's Suspicion, minimum 70 VP, 14 VP per word, -1 per Word.
- || Restore VP, minimum 40 VP, 8VP per word, VP is restored to maximum at end of Turn.
- || Raise max VP, minimum 70 VP, 14 VP per word, VP maximum is increased by 10 at end of Turn (can increase beyond 100).

HOW TO PLAY 17 - PASS

During a Player's Turn in the Debate Phase, during a turn in a Argument, or potentially after another Player makes a Proposal; they may choose to Pass. When a Player 'Passes', they send a message to the GM saying so. During a Pass, the Player says nothing, not giving a Remark or a Proposal. As such, they do not write a message to go with it, and likewise, they do not lose any VP. Passes in response to a Proposal are never public, and should not be announced by the GM.

HOW TO PLAY 18 - AGREE

After a Player makes a Proposal, another Player may choose to Agree with it. 'Agreeing' with a Proposal causes it to immediately go through, preventing other Players from 'Agreeing' or 'Disagreeing'. Players get the chance to Agree after a Player makes a Proposal and when the GM contacts them asking whether they'd like to Agree, Disagree, or Pass. To Agree, the Player tells the GM that they are doing so, providing a message to go along with it. An Agree always has the following VP costs: minimum 20 VP, 4 VP per Word.

HOW TO PLAY 19 - DISAGREE

After a Player makes a Proposal, another Player may choose to Disagree with it. 'Disagreeing' with a Proposal will start a Argument, and prevent other Players from 'Agreeing' or 'Disagreeing'. Players get the chance to Disagree after a Player makes a Proposal and when the GM contacts them asking whether they'd to Agree, Disagree, or Pass. To Disagree, the Player tells the GM that they are doing so, providing a message to go along with it. A Disagree always has the following VP costs: minimum 20 VP, 4 VP per Word.

HOW TO PLAY 20 - ARGUMENTS

When a Player makes a Proposal, other Players get the chance to Disagree with it. Should they choose to do so, an Argument is started. An Argument is where a Defender (Player who made the Proposal) defends their Proposal against an Attacker (Player who 'Disagreed'). During an Argument, the Attacker and Defender take turns, called Rebuttals, in which they choose to Maintain or Pass. If the Defender ever Passes (by choice or no longer having the VP necessary to Maintain), then their Proposal's effect will be reversed; causing 'raise Suspicion' to turn into 'lower Suspicion', and so on; before going through. If the Attacker ever Passes, then the Defender's Proposal will go through. Once the Argument is resolved, play proceeds as normal. Note that, when a Proposal that lowers Trust is reversed to raise Trust, it is the Attacker who gains the Trust with the Defender's Target (unless the Attacker is the Target, in which case the Trust portion of the Proposal is not reversed).

HOW TO PLAY 21 - MAINTAIN & REBUTTALS

In an Argument, the Defender always gets the 1st Rebuttal, the Attacker gets the 2nd, the Defender gets 3rd, and so on. During the 1st Rebuttal, the cost to Maintain is: minimum 5 VP, 1 VP per Word. But for every subsequent Rebuttal, the cost to Maintain increases the minimum by 5 and the VP per Word by 1 (minimum VP = $5 \times \text{Rebuttal Number}$, VP per Word = $0 + \text{Rebuttal Number}$). When an Argument resolves, the word count of every Rebuttal in the Argument is added to the effectiveness of the Proposal (1 word = +1 effectiveness) before it goes through.



HOW TO PLAY 22 - JUSTICE PHASE

During the Justice Phase, the Players vote to eliminate another Player. All Players must vote, there is no abstaining. The GM will contact each Player for their vote, and will reveal the votes and their voters once they have all been received (Player 1 votes Player 2 be eliminated, etc.). A Player will only be eliminated if they receive half or more of the votes (i.e. if there are 4 Players, a Player will be eliminated at 2-3 votes), and in the event of a tie, neither Player is

eliminated. If an Investigator or the Worshipper is eliminated, L will lose 20 of their maximum VP. At the end of the Justice Phase, whether a Player is eliminated or not, play proceeds to the L's Reasoning and Kira's Judgment Phase.



HOW TO PLAY 23 - L'S REASONING PHASE

During L's Reasoning, the L Player 'investigates' another Player to determine whether they are Kira. During this Phase, L contacts the GM and asks, 'is Kira, [name]?'. To which the GM either responds "Yes" or "No". This Phase cannot be used to determine whether another Player is the Worshipper, and L may only investigate one Player per phase. Once the GM answers in the affirmative, and L knows who Kira is, this Phase is secretly skipped. To preserve the identity

of the L Player and their knowledge, the L's Reasoning Phase is always carried out simultaneously with the Kira's Judgment Phase.



HOW TO PLAY 24 - KIRA'S JUDGMENT PHASE

During Kira's Judgment, the Kira Player chooses whether they would like to eliminate another Player, at the cost of half their current maximum VP. During this Phase, the GM contacts Kira and asks if they would like to eliminate a Player. If Kira replies "No", then the Phase ends, and once L's Reasoning is finished, a new Round begins with the Debate Phase. If Kira replies "Yes", the GM will ask them for the name of the Player they are eliminating, which Kira will then

provide. Once L's Reasoning is finished, the Phase will end, the Player will be eliminated, and a new Round begins with the Debate Phase.

Made by neelophile in 2026. Based on Death Note, created by writer Tsugumi Ohba and illustrator Takeshi Obata; and Death Note: Kira Game (DEATH NOTE キラゲーム), created by Konami. All images are from Death Note: Kira Game.

